Qi Wang

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen 2024–2026
Research Fellow in Finance, Overseas Talent Track
School of Management and Economics

EDUCATION

University of New South Wales, Sydney 2017–2023
Ph.D. in Banking and Finance
Dissertation chair: Ronald W. Masulis
Dean's Award for Outstanding PhD Theses, 2023

University of Sydney 2013–2016
Bachelor of Commerce, First Class Honours in Finance, 2016
Bachelor of Commerce, Accounting and Finance, with Distinction, 2015

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Corporate governance; director and shareholder behavior; Chinese financial markets.
Additional interests: labor economics and behavioral finance.

JOB MARKET PAPER

How Shareholder Voice Shapes Board Agendas

with Nadya Malenko (Boston College) and Ronald W. Masulis (University of New South Wales)

Board voting offers an incomplete picture of director influence, overlooking board agenda-setting and board–shareholder meeting interactions. Using unique corporate disclosures in China, we examine the full decision process—from board agenda formation to shareholder voting. Minority blockholder-affiliated directors connect board decisions to shareholder voting by bringing minority investors' voting power into board deliberations. Exploiting a policy shock that increases visibility of dissent at shareholder meetings, we find that stronger shareholder voice amplifies these directors' influence on agenda setting: tunneling proposals are less likely to reach board agendas, especially when they require shareholder approval. The effect also extends to proposals not requiring shareholder approval, consistent with minority blockholders using opposition to other shareholder-meeting proposals as a bargaining lever.

Conferences and seminars: AEA/ASSA 2027 (scheduled); SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific 2026 (scheduled); Global Corporate Governance Colloquia (GCGC) 2026; FMA European 2026; Eastern Finance Association 2026 (accepted); CFAM 2025; China Financial Research Conference (CFRC) 2024; FMA Annual 2024; AsianFA 2024; FMCG 2024; AFBC 2023; SBFC 2023. Seminars: University of New South Wales; Central University of Finance and Economics; Capital University of Economics and Business; Shandong University; Chinese Academy of Sciences.
Media: European Corporate Governance Institute (ECGI) blog.

OTHER WORKING PAPERS

Monitoring Without Dissent: Director Communication Before Board Meetings

with Nadya Malenko (Boston College) and Ronald W. Masulis (University of New South Wales)

Unanimous board votes can reflect active monitoring before the meeting, rather than weak oversight. Using unique Chinese board disclosures, we find that greater opportunities for pre-vote director communication are associated with fewer board proposals raising agency concerns. Vote delegation following personal shocks to attendance captures pre-vote director contact and shows that pre-vote coordination among independent directors and bargaining with insiders are associated with fewer agency-concerning proposals on the board agenda. Director absence and remote participation, which do not require pre-vote director contact, show no significant reduction in such proposals. Exploiting a policy reform that expands pre-vote communication among independent directors, we find that broader communication improves firm value, especially when the committee that screens problematic proposals before the reform is not independent.

Conferences and seminars: FMA Annual 2026; FMA European 2026 (accepted); AEA/ASSA 2025; FMCG 2024. Seminars: Xiamen University; CUHK-Shenzhen.

Post-Voice Share Sales and Purchases: Analysis of Blockholder Strategic Behavior after their Directors Vote against a Board Proposal

with Ronald W. Masulis (University of New South Wales)

By exploiting the public disclosure of Chinese board proposals and director voting, we find that minority shareholders sell more shares after their appointed directors dissent in boardroom voting, while the largest shareholder is more apt to buy shares. Smaller minority shareholders sell more shares than larger minority shareholders. Minority-shareholder-appointed directors' dissents on tunneling-related proposals trigger negative share price impacts, and the dissenting minority shareholders subsequently do not significantly sell or buy shares. However, the price impacts are statistically insignificant for disclosure-related dissent from minority-shareholder-appointed directors, and the dissenting minority shareholders subsequently sell more shares. These patterns suggest that the price impact of voice influences whether 'voice' and 'exit' are substitutes or complements. 'Voice' and 'exit' act as substitutes for dissent on tunneling-related but act as complements for disclosure-related proposals. The phenomenon that smaller minority shareholders sell more than larger minority shareholders is mainly found in disclosure-related dissenting votes. Finally, when the largest-shareholder-appointed directors decide to dissent on more disclosure-related proposals than tunneling-related ones, the ex-ante largest shareholding is smaller. However, if the largest shareholding is not too small and buying for control is not too costly, then the dissenting largest shareholder often buys more shares afterward.

Mandated Green, Masked Tunneling: Stakeholder Pressure-Induced Shareholder Expropriation

with Cong Wang (The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen)

We find that pressure on firms to advance stakeholder interests can intensify conflicts between controlling and minority shareholders. Using unique data on board agendas in China, we exploit the staggered rollout of central environmental inspection policies to study private firms' responses to public environmental pressure. Greater public environmental pressure shifts board agendas toward green projects but with greater tunneling concerns (related-party transactions), without a corresponding increase in arm's-length green projects. Directors representing large minority blockholders constrain the initiation of these green tunneling projects. However, these projects' green label weakens regulatory and shareholder scrutiny towards tunneling. Our findings suggest that controllers can exploit the public legitimacy of green projects while shifting the associated green costs to minority shareholders through tunneling.

Public Policy, Polarized Shareholders

with Yiyang Zou (New York University) and Jianhong Long (University of New South Wales)

Social policy can encourage pro-social shareholders' activism while leaving other shareholders polarized. We study the staggered expansion of Medicaid across U.S. states to examine how socially-oriented state policies shape shareholder engagement through socially-oriented shareholder proposals. Firms headquartered in expansion states reflect a shift toward more pro-social norms in those states and receive more pro-social proposals from shareholders. However, these socially oriented proposals become more likely to be withdrawn and receive less support when they reach a vote, reflecting disapproval from other shareholders. Our findings suggest that public enforcement of socially oriented policies can intensify polarization among shareholders in their attitudes toward firms' social responsibilities.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

There Is No Such Thing as Bad Publicity: Corporate Scandal Experience and Entry-Level Job Interviews

with Bohui Zhang (The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen) and Kemin Wang (Fudan University)

Corporate scandals can damage a firm's reputation while increasing its visibility in the competition for attention. Using a randomized field experiment in China, we examine how these competing effects shape the interview prospects of entry-level candidates with experience at scandal-tainted firms when they apply for new jobs. Fictitious résumés listing experience at scandal-tainted firms receive interview callbacks at a rate of 10.5%, compared with 6% for applications listing experience at firms without scandals, representing a 75% increase. Rational factors such as labor-market conditions, the characteristics of recruiting firms and former employers, and applicants' other characteristics do not explain the result. Public attention to scandals, measured by Baidu search volume, explains substantial variation in callback rates. The findings suggest that the benefits of attention can outweigh concerns associated with a former employer's misconduct, which reveals how corporate visibility can benefit former employees when they compete for attention in the job market.

EARLIER STAGE PROJECTS

Decoding Hidden Political Preferences: Evidence from Video and Multimodal Large Language Models

with Zhiwei Hua (Fudan University) and Yuheng Wang (Central University of Finance and Economics)

A Series of Other Research Projects on Chinese Boards and Shareholders

with Nadya Malenko (Boston College) and Ronald W. Masulis (University of New South Wales)

RESEARCH DATA AND COMPUTING

Original and unique data: Hand-collected (with LLM assistance) Chinese corporate governance data covering approximately 1.2 million board proposals and 10 million individual director votes, including unanimous and dissenting votes across director types. Linked to shareholder meeting proposals, voting outcomes, and stakeholder reactions to study the full corporate decision process.

Programming: Stata, SAS, and Python; AI-assisted coding with Codex, Claude Code, and Cursor; development of AI-agent tools for academic research workflows.

Data platforms: CSMAR, CNINFO, CNRDS, Wind, WRDS (CRSP and Compustat), and BoardEx, e.t.c.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen 2024–2026

Occasional Ph.D. lectures in FIN6301 Advanced Topics in Corporate Finance I, covering boards and research design using distinctive data and the Chinese setting. Guest lecturer in "AI for Marketing".

University of New South Wales 2017–2019

Tutor, FINS1612 Capital Markets and Institutions and FINS1613 Business Finance.
Average teaching evaluation: 5/6.

University of Sydney 2016

Tutor, FINC3013 Mergers and Acquisitions.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference review committees: FMA Asia/Pacific 2024; FMA Annual 2024; Eastern Finance Association 2025.

Session chair: Australasian Finance and Banking Conference, 2023.

Assisted the revision of the Australia and New Zealand chapter in The Oxford Handbook of Banking, 4th edition.

ADDITIONAL TRAINING AND QUALIFICATIONS

UNSW doctoral coursework in empirical corporate governance (Ronald W. Masulis) and empirical corporate finance (Renée Adams); doctoral courses at UNSW and FIRN, e.g., courses by Michelle Lowry and Ernst Maug.

CFA Program, Level III candidate. Languages: Mandarin (native); English (fluent).

ADDITIONAL AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

HDR Completion Scholarship, UNSW, 2022; UNSW Tuition Fee Scholarship, 2017; University of Sydney Academic Merit Prize, 2016.

REFERENCES

Ronald W. Masulis (Dissertation chair and primary advisor)
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